VIT Bhopal University CSE0001 — Digital Literacy Project Report

Student Digital Ambassador Portfolio

Submitted by:

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Introduction

In the modern academic and professional landscape, digital literacy is no longer just a technical skill but a fundamental necessity for success. This project serves as a comprehensive portfolio of my journey as a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador. My primary objective in this role is to bridge the gap between basic computer usage and professional digital citizenship, helping my peers navigate online platforms safely and effectively.

Throughout this project, I have completed five core tasks that map to the essential modules of the Digital Literacy course. These tasks range from designing visual awareness resources and building a professional online presence to mastering cloud collaboration and understanding the complexities of cybercrime prevention. This report documents my technical progress, the tools I have mastered—such as GitHub, Hacker Rank, and Canva—and my reflections on how these digital competencies will support my long-term academic and professional goals at VIT Bhopal University.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used: Canva

I created my Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using **Canva**, a popular online design tool that provides a wide range of templates, icons, and layout options. Canva made the design process simple and efficient, allowing me to organize information in a structured and visually appealing way without requiring advanced graphic design skills.

The main purpose of my infographic is to help students understand what digital literacy is and why it is important in today's digital world. My design includes several key sections such as the definition of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Each section is presented using short, clear points along with relevant icons and color-coded backgrounds. This makes the information easy to read, visually attractive, and more engaging for viewers. I focused on keeping the content simple so that anyone can quickly understand and apply these concepts in real life.

One of the main challenges I faced was balancing the amount of information with the design. Since an infographic should not look crowded, I had to carefully select only the most important points and present them briefly. At the same time, I wanted the design to look creative and organized. I found it interesting to experiment with different colors, fonts, and layouts to improve the overall appearance.

Overall, this project helped me enhance my digital design skills, creativity, and understanding of responsible and effective use of technology in daily life.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Chosen: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

I have created and updated my profiles on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle** as part of building my professional digital presence. Each of these platforms serves a unique purpose in my academic and career growth.

GitHub is mainly used for hosting and showcasing coding projects. I plan to regularly upload my programming assignments, personal projects, and collaborative work to demonstrate my technical skills and consistency.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I can connect with peers, professors, and industry professionals. I have updated my education details and will continue to build my profile by adding skills, certifications, and achievements. Over time, I aim to use LinkedIn to explore internship opportunities and build a strong professional network.

Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning practice. I plan to participate in competitions, work on datasets, and improve my problem-solving abilities in real-world scenarios.

Over the next four years, I will actively maintain these platforms to document my learning journey, build a strong portfolio, and enhance my career opportunities.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used: Hacker Rank, Google Forms, and Google Sheets.

Reflection and Technical Journey: For Task 3, I focused on bridging the gap between technical problem-solving and digital collaboration. As a student in the CSE (AIML) program, I recognized that platforms like **Hacker Rank** are essential for building the algorithmic thinking required for my future career. I have completed THE **SOLVE ME FIRST CHALLENGE.** Solving this challenge taught me how to write efficient code under pressure and helped me move beyond simple syntax to actual logic-based programming.

For this second task in my project on cybercrime awareness, I primarily used **Google Forms**, a free and widely accessible platform provided by Google. It allowed me to design and deploy a structured quiz without requiring any technical or coding knowledge, making it practical for academic use within a college setting.

Using **Google Forms**, I built a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz covering topics such as UPI fraud, phishing identification, safe password practices, and cybercrime reporting channels. I manually researched each question using online resources including government advisories, RBI consumer awareness bulletins, and news articles related to cybercrime in India. The checklist and case study components were drafted independently using Microsoft Word, drawing on information gathered through Google Search and CERT-In publications.

By linking the form to a **Google Sheet**, I learned how to automate data collection and organize responses in real-time. This experience showed me how powerful cloud tools are for teamwork and data management.

Mastering these platforms has given me a solid foundation for my B.Tech journey. I now feel much more confident using industry-standard tools to document my progress and collaborate effectively with my batchmates and professors.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Tool Used: Gmail / MS Outlook

1. Professional Email Drafts As part of this task, I developed two professional emails to practice formal digital communication. The first is a request for an assignment deadline extension sent to a professor, and the second is an inquiry to an internship coordinator.

- **Email 1 Subject:** Request for Extension: Digital Literacy Module Assignment – Aryan Srivastava-25BAI10108
- **Email 2 Subject:** Inquiry: Summer Internship Opportunity – Aryan Srivastava - VIT Bhopal

2. Social Media Do's and Don'ts To promote responsible digital citizenship, I created the following guidelines for college students:

Do's:

1. **Privacy – keep your profile private or semi – private**
2. **Professionalism – Thing before you post – ask: "would my lecturer see this ?'**
3. **Fact checking– Verify information before sharing or reposting**
4. **Positive conduct – use social media to share achievements and learning**
5. **Engagement – Engage respectfully in discussions and debates.**

Don'ts:

1. **Personal info – Never share your address phone number, or schedule**
2. **Hate Speech – Do not post offensive , racist , or hateful content**
3. **Cyberbullying- do not target,mock, or harass classmates online**
4. **Oversharing – Do not post your real-time location or travel plans**
5. **Illegal Content – Do not share pirated content , explicit material , or defamatory.**

Communication Scenario and Reflection

One situation where poor digital communication caused a serious problem can be seen in a hypothetical college group project scenario. A team of students was assigned a presentation, and they decided to coordinate their work through a messaging app. One member shared important instructions about the topic division and submission deadline, but the message was written in a very unclear and informal way. Some students misunderstood their roles, while others completely missed the deadline because they did not check the messages carefully.

As a result, the group submitted an incomplete project, which affected everyone's grades. This situation created confusion, frustration, and conflict among team members. The main issue here was the lack of clear, professional, and structured communication. Important details like deadlines, responsibilities, and expectations were not communicated properly.

This problem could have been avoided by following basic digital communication practices. Firstly, the group should have used clear and formal language while sharing instructions. Secondly, important information should have been highlighted using bullet points or separate messages to avoid confusion. Thirdly, they could have used more reliable platforms like email or shared documents (such as Google Docs) to track progress and responsibilities. Regular follow-ups and confirmations from all members would also have ensured that everyone was on the same page.

In conclusion, effective digital communication is essential for teamwork and productivity. Clear, respectful, and well-structured communication can prevent misunderstandings and ensure successful outcomes in both academic and professional environments.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Personal Reflection

The most surprising discovery while researching UPI and online payment fraud was how psychologically precise these scams are. I had assumed cybercriminals relied primarily on technical exploits — hacking systems or breaking encryption. The reality is far simpler and more unsettling: they exploit basic human emotions like urgency, trust, and the fear of losing money. The "collect request" trick, for instance, requires zero technical skill from the fraudster. It works purely because victims don't yet understand that a UPI PIN is an authorisation tool, not an identity verifier.

What also struck me was the scale — the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre logged over 1.5 million cybercrime complaints in 2023 alone, with financial fraud forming the largest category.

The one habit I will personally change is verifying every UPI collect request by calling the sender directly before entering my PIN — no exceptions, regardless of how familiar or urgent the message appears.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy Portfolio has been a transformative experience in understanding my role as a Student Digital Ambassador. Through these five modules, I have transitioned from a passive internet user to an active, professional digital citizen. I now possess the technical skills to manage a GitHub repository, the communication skills to draft professional correspondence, and the critical awareness to identify sophisticated cyber threats.

This project taught me that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about using them safely, ethically, and strategically. Whether it is collaborating through cloud-based platforms or protecting my financial identity from phishing, these competencies are essential for my academic journey at VIT Bhopal and my future career in the global workforce. I am now better equipped to guide my peers and maintain a permanent, professional digital footprint.

References

- **Canva** (Infographic tool): canva.com
- **GitHub** (Portfolio hosting): github.com
- **Hacker Rank** (Coding practice): hackerrank.com
- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal**